



Twitch is getting a new look

Eight years since its launch, streaming platform Twitch is getting a new look.
<https://dgit.in/oct19-45>



Robodog 'Spot' is taking jobs

Boston Dynamics' uncanny robot 'dog' Spot is now available for lease by companies.
<https://dgit.in/oct19-36>

a direct route with minimal number of hops. This way, you are destined to get even better pings.

However, these specialised VPNs only make such arrangements for the popular multiplayer titles where low ping really matters. The best part of all this is that motherboard vendors and even routers have started incorporating these VPNs. While motherboards have had them for ages, the routers are doing a better job. Units such as the Netgear XR500 and ASUS ROG Rapture RT-AC2900 have dedicated features and have plenty of options to manually configure the same so that you can get the best possible experience with whichever multiplayer video game you might be playing. I found both of these to have an easy and feature-rich UI pertaining to improving your experience. There are many other brands who have dedicated gaming routers and even more with just gimmicks being peddled as "gaming focused". I ended up getting two different subscriptions of these services despite having a dedicated gaming router.

I got Mudfish for Guild Wars and NordVPN for dauntless. And WTFast which is baked into my router works well with World of Tanks ASIA. That's because I play a couple of multiplayer games of which few are popular enough to be on the radar of the underlying GPNs. For the rest, I still have to pester my ISP to sort out all routing issues. 

BUYING ADVICE

BETTER THAN MY PEERS

Q Hello Agent001,
 I am an avid reader of Digit magazine for the past 3 years. I am looking for a gaming laptop in a price range of ₹50000/- I don't usually



MSI GL63 9RCX

game much, but the reason to get a gaming laptop is performance.

All my friends bought Intel Core i5 laptops and still those hang while processing 5-6 chrome tabs. Then I decided to buy a gaming laptop as I happen to be looking more for performance.

So basically, I just watch a lot of movies, I'm into coding stuff, run heavy programs like MATLAB and also do a bit of video processing. Agent001, Please suggest a laptop that is suited to my needs. Thanks

—Pranay Mokida

A Hey Pranay,
 Laptops slow down for a multitude of reasons and having an Intel Core i5 machine start to slow down with just 5-6 tabs seems a little over the top. Your friends must not be tak-

ing care of their machines. Perhaps a little cleanup of unwanted background processes and even cleaning the cooling fans might help with their dilemma. Heating can cause the CPU to throttle which will cause the aforementioned scenarios to occur. Coming to your needs, you'd need a good CPU for MATLAB since the GPU acceleration depends on the kind of application that you write. For most folks, the GPU will only be used for rendering the visuals and not for compute unless the code has been written to make use of CUDA. Video processing is also heavy on the CPU rather than the GPU. You're better off with an Intel 9th Gen Core i7 or i9 CPU if your use case is indeed heavy. However, you're not going to find either of these in a laptop around the ₹50K range. At most, you'll get a Core i5-9300H along with an NVIDIA GTX 1050 Ti starting from ₹65K, which would be



ASUS TUF FX505DT

the MSI GL63 9RCX. An AMD Processor should also do fine and you can get the ASUS FX505DT for around ₹60K with the GTX 1650 GPU. Both configurations are good. Whether the machine will be crawling after opening 5-6 Chrome tabs is entirely upon the way you use it. 



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